

HACKATHON PREMIER LEAGUE

HPL 2026

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

Shri Madhwa Vadiraja Institute of Technology and Management

Registration: 2 – 6 September 2026

Shortlist Announcement: 8 September 2026

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1. About HPL

Hackathon Premier League (HPL) 2026 is a three-week hackathon organized by Shri Madhwa Vadiraja Institute of Technology and Management (SMVITM). HPL challenges students to develop innovative and practical solutions to real-world problems using technology.

Participants will work in teams, propose their solutions during registration, and shortlisted teams will proceed to the subsequent stages of the competition.

2. Eligibility

- HPL 2026 is open only to students of Shri Madhwa Vadiraja Institute of Technology and Management.
- Participants may belong to any year or department.
- Inter-departmental team formation is encouraged.

3. Team Formation

- Each team must consist of exactly 5 members.
- Teams may be formed freely by the participants.
- A participant can be part of only one team.
- Teams are encouraged to have members from different departments.
- The team composition cannot be changed once the registration form is submitted.
- Any correction or issue regarding registration details must be communicated to an HPL Coordinator.

4. Registration

Registration Period

2 September 2026 – 6 September 2026

Registration closes at 11:59 PM on 6 September 2026.

Each team must submit the following:

- Team Name
- Team Leader Name
- Team Leader Email ID
- Team Leader Contact Number
- Names of all team members

- Email IDs of all team members
- Selected Problem Statement
- Solution Video – Google Drive link

Teams may choose any one of the three official problem statements.

Important: The selected problem statement cannot be changed after the registration form is submitted.

5. Problem Statements

Important: This problem statements are only for shortlisting. Actual Problem Statements will be given after shortlisting

PS 01 — WeatherGPT: Conversational AI for Weather Forecasting, Alerts, and Climate Information

A conversational AI solution that provides accurate weather forecasts, severe weather alerts, and climate insights through natural-language interaction.

Key Focus Areas:

- Weather forecasting
- Severe weather alerts
- Climate information
- Natural-language interaction
- Conversational AI

PS 02 — Rural Market Intelligence

Develop a data-driven solution that empowers farmers and rural businesses with real-time market insights, price trends, demand prediction, and supply chain intelligence to make smarter decisions and maximize income.

Key Focus Areas:

- Price tracking & trends
- Demand forecasting & insights
- Supply chain transparency
- Rural empowerment

Technology Areas:

- Data Analytics
- IoT
- Agritech
- Business Intelligence

Evaluation Pillars:

- Problem Understanding
- Functionality
- User Experience
- Technical Implementation
- Innovation
- Practicality

PS 03 — Internship and Opportunity Aggregator

Build a smart platform that aggregates internships, jobs, scholarships, and opportunities from across the web, and helps students discover the right opportunities based on their skills, interests, and goals.

Key Focus Areas:

- Smart search & filtering
- Personalized recommendations
- Real-time alerts & notifications
- Trusted & verified opportunities

Technology Areas:

- Web Development
- AI/ML
- Data Aggregation
- UX/UI

Evaluation Pillars:

- Problem Understanding
- Functionality
- User Experience
- Technical Implementation
- Innovation
- Practicality

6. Registration Video

Every team must submit a video demonstrating their proposed solution as part of registration.

The video must include:

1. Project Walkthrough — Demonstrate the proposed solution.
2. Technology Stack — Mention the technologies being used.

3. Technology Justification — Explain why the chosen technologies were selected.
4. Problem Solving Approach — Explain how the solution addresses the selected problem statement.
5. Uniqueness — Explain what makes the proposed solution unique or innovative.

Video Requirements:

- Maximum duration: 3 minutes.
- The video must not exceed 3 minutes.
- The video must be uploaded to Google Drive.
- The Google Drive link must be submitted in the registration form.
- Sharing permission must be set to "Anyone with the link".
- The video file name must be the team name.

If the submitted video cannot be accessed, the HPL team will contact the concerned team through email to resolve the access issue.

7. Shortlisting

- All registered teams will undergo an initial shortlisting process.
- The shortlisted teams will be announced on the official HPL website on 8 September 2026.
- Further stages, requirements, and timelines will be communicated during the HPL inauguration.

8. Technology & AI Usage

Technology Freedom

There are no restrictions on the technology stack. Teams are free to use the technologies, programming languages, frameworks, platforms, APIs, libraries, and tools of their choice.

AI Usage

Participants are permitted to use AI tools and services while developing their solutions.

9. Shortlisted Team Registration Fee

A registration fee will apply only to shortlisted teams.

Team	Fee
Team with no IEEE member	₹200 / team
Team with at least one IEEE member	₹150 / team

10. Cancellation & Refund Policy

- Teams may cancel their participation at any time.
- The team must inform any HPL Coordinator regarding the cancellation.
- Once the shortlisted-team registration fee has been paid, it is non-refundable, even if the team subsequently cancels its participation.

11. Code of Conduct & Fair Play

- Submit original work and avoid plagiarism.
- Do not copy or misuse another team's work.
- Do not access another team's code, accounts, systems, or data without authorization.
- Do not intentionally disrupt or sabotage another team's work.
- Do not attempt to manipulate the evaluation process.
- Maintain respectful and professional behaviour toward participants, coordinators, mentors, and judges.
- Harassment, bullying, discrimination, or inappropriate behaviour is not permitted.
- Follow applicable licenses and terms when using third-party software, libraries, APIs, or resources.

Any form of cheating, plagiarism, misconduct, or unfair practice may result in disqualification.

The decision of the HPL organizing committee regarding rule violations will be final.

12. Important Dates

Date	Event
2 September 2026	Registration Opens
6 September 2026	Registration Closes
8 September 2026	Shortlisted Teams Announced
8 September 2026	HPL Inauguration
Further Stages	Details announced during the inauguration

13. Certificates

Certificates will be provided to participants as per the HPL organizing committee's guidelines.

14. Official Communication

- All official announcements, updates, and important information regarding HPL will be communicated through email.
- Participants are responsible for regularly checking the email address provided during registration.

15. General Rules

- Participants must provide accurate information during registration.
- Each participant can register with only one team.
- Each team must have exactly 5 members.
- Teams may select any one of the three problem statements.
- Team composition and selected problem statement are fixed after form submission.
- Any required correction to submitted registration information must be communicated to an HPL Coordinator.
- Participants must follow all instructions communicated by the HPL organizing committee during the subsequent stages.